

A private transcript of any meeting, on your own computer.

This short guide shows you how to install Volksmond and how to use it day to day. Built for Afrikaans, English, and the way people actually switch between them.

Speak freely • Praat vrylik

by DigiPhyte



Everything happens on your computer.

Your audio and your transcripts are never uploaded. Volksmond does not phone home. Once the models are downloaded, you can use it completely offline.

IN THIS GUIDE



Part 1, Install it once

Unzip the folder, open the app, and get past the one Windows warning. Takes a few minutes, the first time only.



Part 2, Use it

Transcribe a live meeting, a recording you already have, or record now and transcribe later. Summarise on your machine.

Part 1 Install it once

You were sent a single file named `Volksmond.zip`. There is nothing to install in the usual sense. You unzip it, then run the app straight from the folder.

1 Unzip the folder

Right-click `Volksmond.zip` and choose **Extract All**. Pick a normal place to keep it, like your Documents folder. Open the folder it creates. Run the app from there, not from inside the zip preview.

2 Open the app

In the unzipped folder, double-click `Volksmond.exe`. The Volksmond window opens on its own. The other files next to it are part of the app, you can leave them alone.

3 If Windows shows a blue warning

You may see **Windows protected your PC**. Click `More info`, then `Run anyway`. This appears only because the app is new and not yet signed by a certificate. It is the same file you were sent, and it is safe. You will not see this again on this computer.

4 Answer the short setup

A welcome screen greets you, then asks one question: do you want to **just transcribe**, or also **summarise** on your machine. For summaries, pick a model size and Volksmond downloads it for you in one click. You can skip this and turn summaries on later in Settings.



One thing needs the internet, once.

The first time you transcribe, Volksmond downloads the speech model it runs on (this is a one-time download and it needs an internet connection that one time). After that, transcription and summaries run entirely on your computer, offline.

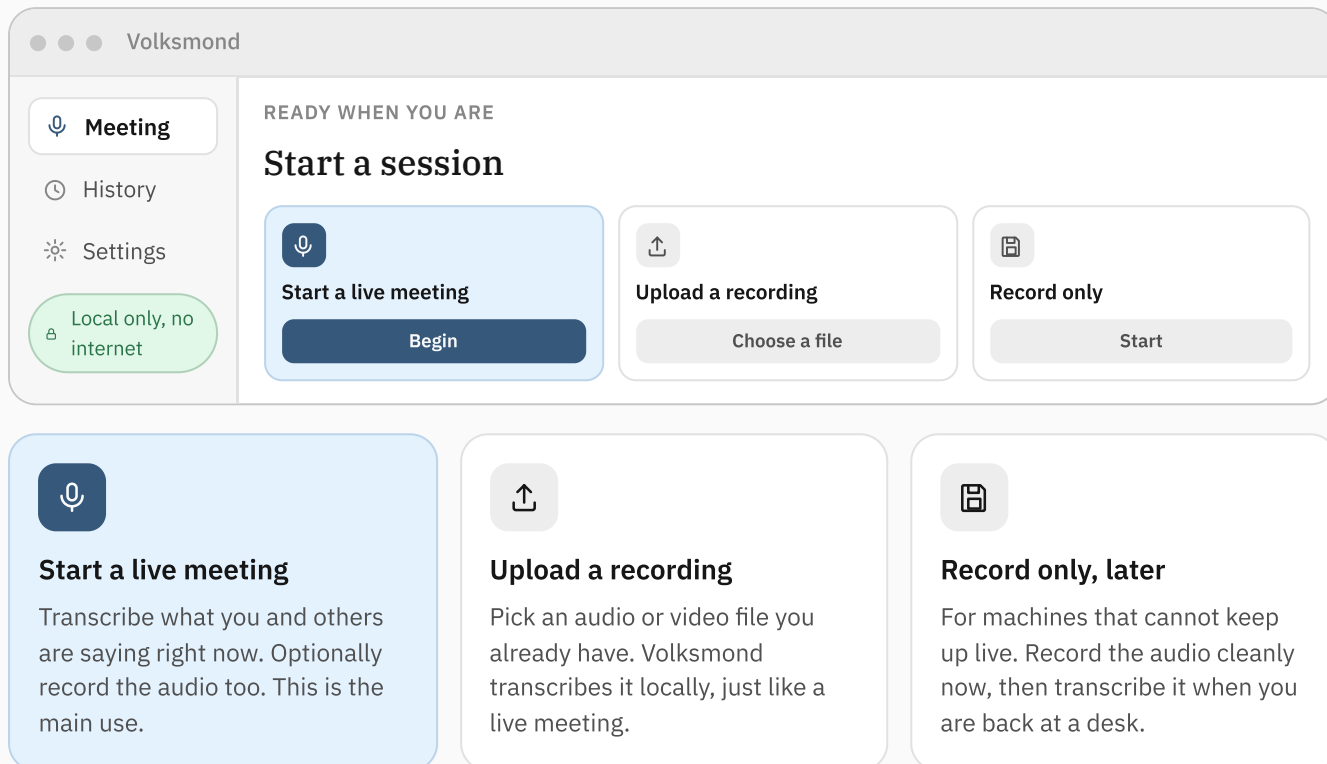


Choosing a summary model

Two sizes, both free and both run on your machine. **Gemma 4 (2 billion)** is lighter and faster, and works well on most computers. **Gemma 4 (4 billion)** is a little more polished and needs more memory. If unsure, start with the 2 billion.

Part 2 Use it

When the app opens you land on the **Meeting** screen. This is where every session starts. There are three ways in, pick the one that fits the moment.



RUNNING A LIVE MEETING

-  **Set it up, then press Begin**
Give the meeting a title, choose the language (Afrikaans, English, or Auto-detect) and a quality level. Adding the **names and jargon** you expect to hear genuinely improves accuracy, especially for Afrikaans and the mix. All of this is optional.
-  **Two audio sources**
Your microphone picks up your voice. **System audio** picks up everyone else, the sound coming out of your computer. So Volksmond captures both sides of a Teams, Zoom, or Meet call you have joined as a guest. Tip: wear headphones, so the microphone does not re-hear the other people and transcribe them twice.
-  **Watch it, then stop and save**
The transcript appears live as people talk. When you are done, press **Stop and save**. If you were also recording the audio, a small menu lets you stop the recording, the transcript, or both.

AFTER A MEETING



Open, read, or copy it

The transcript is saved as a plain text file. From the finished screen you can open the folder, open the transcript to read it, or copy it all to paste elsewhere.



Summarise it, on your machine

If you turned summaries on, press **Summarise** for the decisions, the to-dos, and what stayed open. Choose the summary in **English or Afrikaans**. It runs locally and saves next to the transcript.



Find it again in History

The **History** tab lists every past meeting. Search it, open any transcript to re-read or summarise, and re-transcribe any recording you kept.

Strategy review · 04:18 · Listening

- 00:02 **MIC** So as ek dink aan die nuwe plan,
00:09 **SYS** Yes, and the budget side of it too.
00:15 **MIC** Ons kan dit volgende kwartaal begin.
00:21 **SYS** Agreed. I will pull the numbers.

SETTINGS WORTH KNOWING

Make it yours

Appearance: light, dark, or follow Windows. **Interface language:** switch the whole app between English and Afrikaans. **Default context:** save the names and jargon you use often, applied to every meeting.

Where your files live

Under **Data and privacy** you can change the folder transcripts save to. For maximum privacy, pick a folder that a cloud service (OneDrive, Google Drive, Dropbox) does not sync. Audio recording stays off unless you switch it on for a meeting.



Your privacy, in plain terms

Nothing you say or transcribe is ever sent off your computer. Volksmond has no accounts and no telemetry, and the offline edition has no way to reach the internet once the models are in place. The source code is available so anyone can confirm it never phones home.

NEED A HAND



Report a bug or an idea

Use **Report a bug or idea** at the bottom of the side menu. It opens a pre-filled email, nothing is sent automatically. Write to volksmond@digiphyte.com.



About Volksmond

Said *Fawlks-mawnt*, Afrikaans for the way people actually speak. A DigiPhyte product, built in South Africa. digiphyte.com